

SIPPING GOLD

IN INDIA RUM drinkers are cult worshippers of a monk from the hills. His words are strong and are imbibed with substantial dilution. What is remembered is not the message but the delirium. The idea of a rum so nuanced and layered in its flavours that it is sipped neat, like a single malt is delightful enough to be another deity of inebriation. *Camikara* by Piccadily Distilleries is an answer to the prayers of rum drinkers that have faced taste racism from other spirit worshippers. Unlike most rums that are prepared with sugarcane molasses, Camikara is made with pure cane juice, without any additives. It is a sipping rum aged in ex-bourbon, American oak barrels for 12 years. In that process, only 6.6 per cent of the original filled quantity is left to be savoured as the rest evaporates. What comes to the consumer is a one-of-a-kind luxury drink that is redolent with rich flavours hitherto not experienced in an Indian rum. On the nose, it raises a bouquet of aromas—ginger, honey, and rich fruity notes with a hint of leather. A sip reveals smooth rich notes of dark chocolate, vanilla and fruity after notes with a finish of wood. Camikara received rare international recognition this year—it won the gold medal at the International Wine & Spirit Competition in London, a first for Indian rum. Of the 3,600 bottles, only 1,200 have been set aside for the Indian market, and each bottle is priced at ₹6,200. Taken out of its custom silk-lined case, the rum pours out in a lustrous depiction of its name, which means liquid gold in Sanskrit.